❖ Diseases

Air pollution causes several respiratory and heart problems. Many people have died due to air pollution. Air pollutants cause pneumonia and asthma in children.

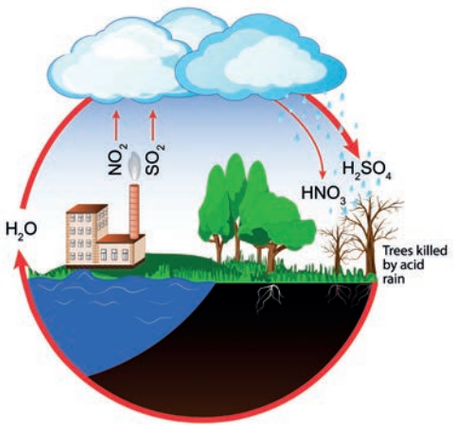
❖ Global warming

Air pollution results in the accumulation of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere. When gases like carbon dioxide are present in the atmosphere in large amount, they increase the atmospheric temperature. With increased temperatures, melting of ice and icebergs in polar regions and increase in sea levels are taking place. It affects the living organisms living there.



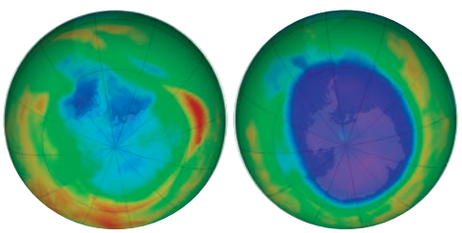
❖ Acid rain

As we saw earlier harmful gases like nitrogen oxides and sulfur oxides are released into the atmosphere while burning fossil fuels. When it rains, the water droplets combine with these gases and fall on the ground in the form of acid rain. Acid rain affects human, animals, and crops.



❖ Depletion of ozone layer

Ozone molecules are present in the Earth's stratosphere and they are responsible for protecting humans from harmful ultraviolet (UV) rays. Chlorofluorocarbons, released into the atmosphere by human activities deplete the ozone layer. As the ozone layer is depleted, UV rays reach the earth and they cause skin and eye related problems to us.



Ozone layer in 1979 | Ozone layer in 2011

❖ Marine life

Large amount of nitrogen present in some fertilisers is washed into the water bodies. They cause the growth of green algae in the seas. This is called Eutrophication. This adversely affects fish, plants and animal species.

❖ Effect on wildlife

Harmful substances present in the air affect wild animals. Wild animals move to a new place when the air is polluted. When their habitat is changed they face extinction.



Do you know?

Chemicals like chlorofluorocarbon (CFC) which are used in refrigerators, spray cans and fire extinguishers, have reduced the amount of ozone in the stratosphere. It has resulted in the depletion of ozone layer in the Antarctic region.